

We have revised premiums across some of our products in this financial year. However, it is pertinent to note that price increases are our last resort. For example, one of our products—Senior Citizen's Red-Carpet policy—had not witnessed a price increase for over 15 years.



What are the challenges that you aim to address?

While the growth opportunity is obvious given the low penetration levels of insurance in India, two key concerns stand out for the health insurance sector: rising medical inflation and insurance fraud.

Medical inflation is a challenge and we address this through better coordination with our 14,000 partner hospitals to ensure affordability and a seamless customer experience.

We have strong partnerships with preferred hospitals to manage costs while ensuring quality care. We believe that for a robust healthcare ecosystem, India needs a healthcare regulator. Hopefully, the government will soon take some measures towards this end.

Insurance fraud is another major issue, with an estimated 10% of health insurance claims being lost due to fraudulent actors.

Unlike banking, where customer credit history, credit scores prevent repeat instances of fraud and abuse, the insurance industry lacks a centralised mechanism to track fraudulent policyholders or hospitals. Addressing this issue is crucial to maintaining fair premiums and claims settlements for genuine customers. At Star Health, we have invested heavily in technology and specialised teams to detect and prevent fraud and abuse.



What are your growth drivers?

Our growth strategy revolves around best-in-class customer service, product innovation and market expansion.

Health insurance in India is highly under penetrated and only about 50 million people have retail health insurance plans. We plan to introduce many innovative products to drive growth and to increase insurance penetration. For example, we have introduced outpatient treatment insurance coverage plans through a fully digital model on our Star Health customer app. We believe this can provide comprehensive coverage to our policyholders.

Star Health is present in more than 17,000 out of the approximately 19,000 PIN codes that are



there in India.

Aligned to the Irdai's vision of 'Insurance for All by 2047', we stay committed to driving deeper penetration of health insurance, especially in semi-urban and rural areas.



How has health insurance changed after Covid-19? There is a general sense that claims have increased significantly. What has driven this surge in claims?